

Incident Response Playbook – Web Application Attack

1. Incident Definition

The incident involves suspicious and malicious web traffic detected on a web application. Abnormal traffic patterns, repeated HTTP error responses, and unauthorized access attempts were identified using Apache web server access logs monitored in Splunk.

2. Detection and Alert Triggers

Detection was performed using Splunk searches on Apache access logs. Traffic spikes, excessive 404 errors, repeated 403 errors, and repeated access to sensitive URLs were used as alert conditions.

3. Severity Classification

Incidents were classified based on impact and intent. Low severity represents normal behavior, medium severity indicates suspicious scanning, high severity indicates active attack attempts, and critical severity represents confirmed compromise.

4. Investigation and Analysis

Log analysis was performed to validate alerts, identify source IPs, analyze error patterns, review targeted URLs, and determine the duration of suspicious activity.

5. Containment Actions

Containment actions included temporarily blocking malicious IP addresses, applying rate limiting, restricting access to sensitive endpoints, and preserving log data for further analysis.

6. Eradication and Recovery

After containment, confirmed malicious sources were permanently blocked, vulnerable configurations were corrected, and security patches were applied. Systems were monitored closely during recovery.

7. Post-Incident Review and Reporting

After resolution, the incident was documented, root cause analysis was performed, lessons learned were identified, and monitoring and response procedures were improved.